

Country Fairs: Agriculture Culture

[B2]

Ogni estate, milioni di britannici visitano queste fiere agricole per incontrare gli animali della fattoria, assaggiare i prodotti artigianali, assistere a spettacoli di ogni tipo e, in generale, celebrare la vita rurale.



British people love country [fairs](#). The UK [holds](#) at least four hundred days of rural events every year, and their popularity is rising all the time. One in ten Britons attends a fair every year, and in 2023, record numbers visited [fairs](#) all over the country. Once just for farmers, today the typical [sheepdog trials](#), [sheep shearing contests](#), [livestock](#) competitions for [best of breed](#), [cider](#), beer and whisky tents, and food [stalls](#) hosting local products are a day out for all the family.

SPREADING KNOWLEDGE

Dating back to the 18th and 19th centuries, country [fairs](#) were originally founded to spread knowledge of new farming technology — part of the Industrial Revolution — among rural populations. That tradition still continues, with hundreds of [trade stands](#) in the fields at agricultural shows today. Stars of the [fairs](#) are the latest high-tech tractors. The Great Yorkshire Show, one of Britain's most popular events, was actually conceived in 1837, when a group of agriculturalists met in York to discuss possible technological [improvements](#) in the farming world. The first show opened in 1838.

BREAKING RECORDS

Country shows are now breaking attendance records year after year. The reasons are social, cultural and financial. The Royal Highland Show, held near Edinburgh every June, has more than two hundred thousand visitors, around a thousand exhibitors, and [boosts](#) the local economy by an incredible £40 million. British people are now very interested in the [sources](#) of their food, as well as particular types of products, such as organic, local, animal-friendly, vegan, [fair-trade](#) or environmentally friendly. Urban visitors are reconnecting with the rural world, looking for artisan cheeses and meats, and [hand-crafted](#) beers and [ciders](#).

FARMING AS ENTERTAINMENT

Nostalgia is actually another reason for the [fairs'](#) success. [strange though it may seem](#), farming has now become part of the entertainment industry! Millions of people watch farmers around the world at work on TV shows and YouTube. People want to return to what they remember as the calm, ordered days of the past. Fairs are now family events, where children can even touch the animals in [petting zoos](#).

Glossary

- **holds** = tenere
- **stalls** = bancarelle
- **boosts** = promuovere, incrementare
- **sources** = origini
- **sheepdog trials** = gare di cani da pastore
- **improvements** = miglioramenti
- **hand-crafted** = artigianale
- **fair-trade** = commercio equo
- **livestock** = bestiame
- **best of breed** = il migliore di razza
- **cider** = sidro
- **trade stands** = banchi commerciali
- **strange though it may seem** = per quanto possa sembrare strano
- **petting zoos** = fattoria didattica
- **fairs** = fiere
- **sheep shearing contests** = gare di tosatura delle pecore